

LEVERAGE STRATEGIC

ACQUISITION & GROWTH CAPITAL OVERVIEW

Solene Skincare Co.

Premium D2C Skincare

May 2026

Transaction Highlights

\$7.8M → \$26.6M

Net Revenue, Year 1–Year 5

~35% CAGR

5-Year Revenue Growth

31.2%

EBITDA Margin, Year 5

4.7x → 7.8x

LTV:CAC Trajectory

\$9.5M

Cash at Exit (Year 5)

\$9.5M

Cash at Exit (Year 5)

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Investment Highlights

Six reasons this business commands attention

Strong, Profitable Growth

Net revenue grows from \$7.8M to \$26.6M over five years (~35% CAGR); EBITDA margin expands from near breakeven to 31.2% — a profile rarely achieved at this stage.

Expanding Gross Margins

Gross margin improves from 61.7% to 69.9% as scale, sourcing efficiencies, and favorable channel mix compound over the plan period.

Exceptional Unit Economics

Blended LTV:CAC of 4.7x in Year 1 — already top-quartile for the category — improving to 7.8x by Year 5 as repeat purchasing matures.

Lean, Scalable Infrastructure

24 FTEs operate the business today; headcount grows only to 38 by Year 5 while revenue per FTE nearly doubles from \$327K to \$700K.

Self-Funding Capital Structure

A \$1.2M term loan and \$600K revolver finance the entire plan; the revolver is fully repaid by Year 3. The Company exits Year 5 with \$9.5M cash.

Founder-Led Brand Equity

Built by a hands-on founder with clean-beauty credibility driving premium pricing and repeat loyalty. Transition via phased exit, earn-out, or operator handover.

Company Snapshot

Solene Skincare Co. is a founder-led, direct-to-consumer skincare brand built around clean, disciplined product line, and a loyal, repeat-driven customer base.

Since launch, the Company has scaled from a single-channel DTC business to a 24-person organization spanning marketing, creative, customer experience, supply chain, and finance — while preserving the founder's original product philosophy and brand voice.

The Company is now evaluating a transaction — acquisition, growth equity, or a credit facility — to fund the channel and geographic expansion outlined in its five-year plan.

2021

Founded

United States

Headquarters

24 FTEs

Employees

DTC / Amazon / Wholesale

Channels

US, Canada, UK (Plan)

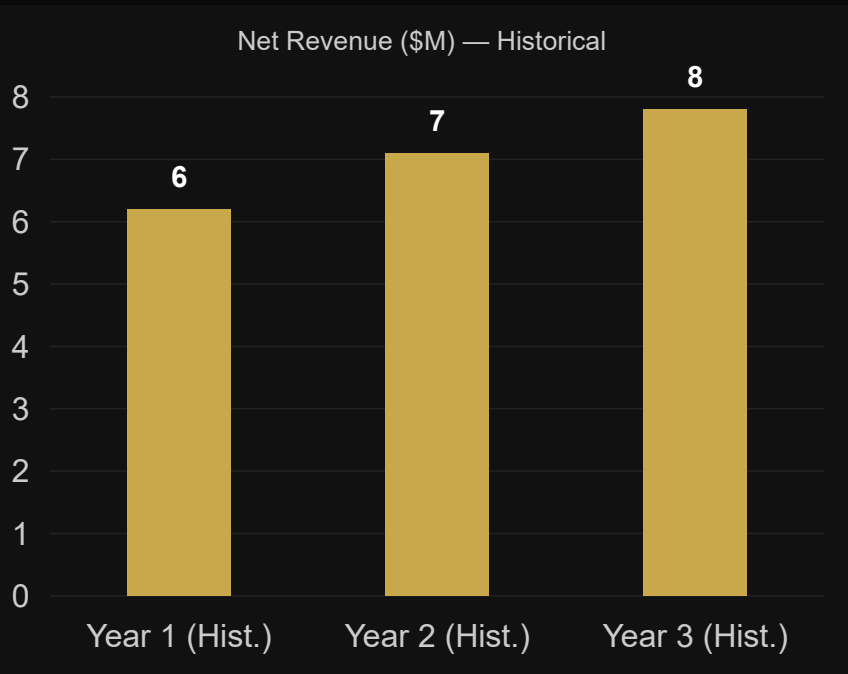
Markets

Premium Clean Skincare

Category

Track Record of Growth

Audited and management-account performance, Year 1 through Year 3



\$7.8M

Net Revenue (Y3)

~26%

2-Year Revenue CAGR

61.7%

Gross Margin (Y3)

>30%

Repeat Order Share (Y3)

Cohort & Retention Analysis

Retention curves and cumulative LTV by acquisition cohort

~45%

Year-1 Repeat Rate (Base)

Customers reordering within 12 months of first purchase

4.7x

LTV:CAC, Year 1 Blended

Top-quartile for DTC clean beauty; improving to 7.8x by Y5

\$164

Average LTV at 24 Months

Based on avg AOV × repeat frequency × gross margin

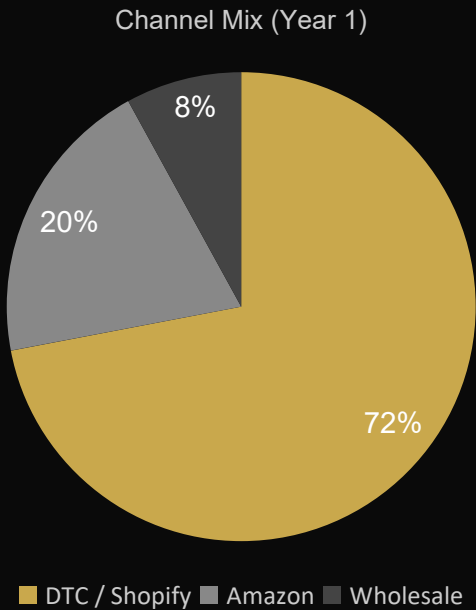
30%+

Repeat Orders, Year 1

Repeat share grows to >50% by Year 5

Revenue Breakdown — Year 1

Channel, SKU, and geography composition



Geography	Revenue	% of Total
United States	\$6.8M	87%
Canada	\$0.6M	8%
United Kingdom	\$0.4M	5%

Channel split, SKU revenue, and geography mix reflect management accounts for Year 1.

Marketing Engine & Channel Economics

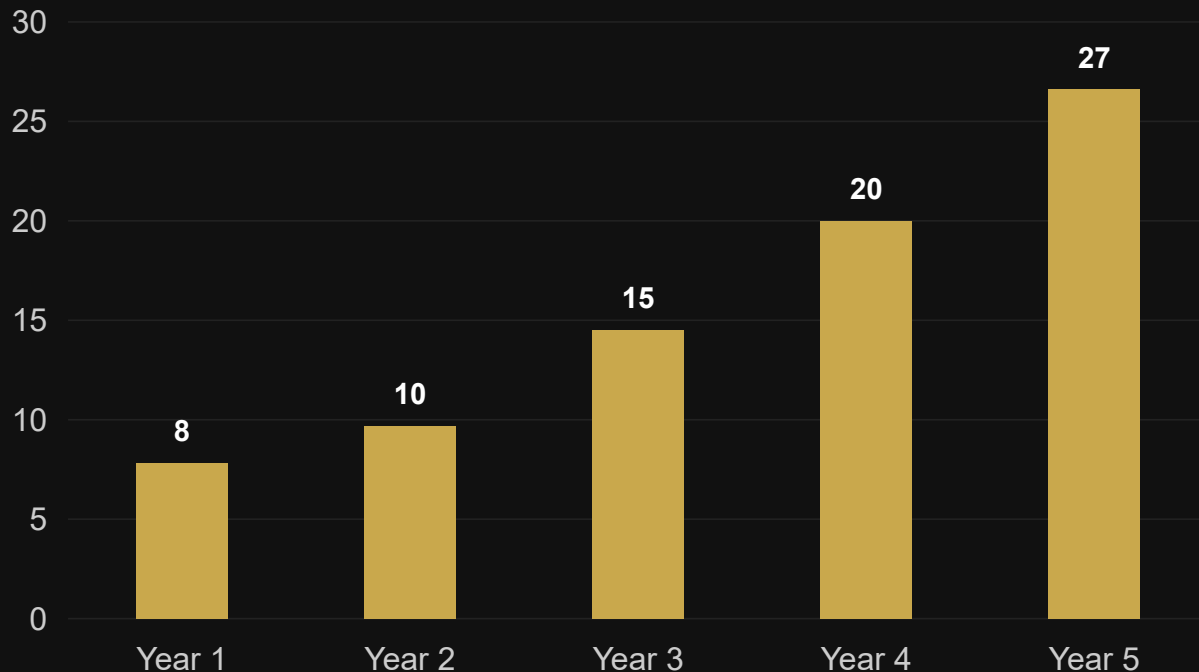
CAC, MER, and funnel performance by channel

Channel	CAC (\$)	MER (x)	% of Spend
Meta / Instagram	\$38	3.1x	45%
Google / Search	\$42	2.8x	25%
Influencer / UGC	\$29	4.2x	15%
Affiliate	\$24	5.0x	8%
Organic / Email	\$0	∞	7%
Blended	\$35	3.5x	100%

MER doubles from Jan to Dec as the active repeat customer base grows — structural efficiency improvement, not spend optimization.

Revenue Growth Trajectory

Net Revenue (\$mm) — Year 1 through Year 5



~35%

Net Revenue CAGR
Y1 → Y5

3.4x

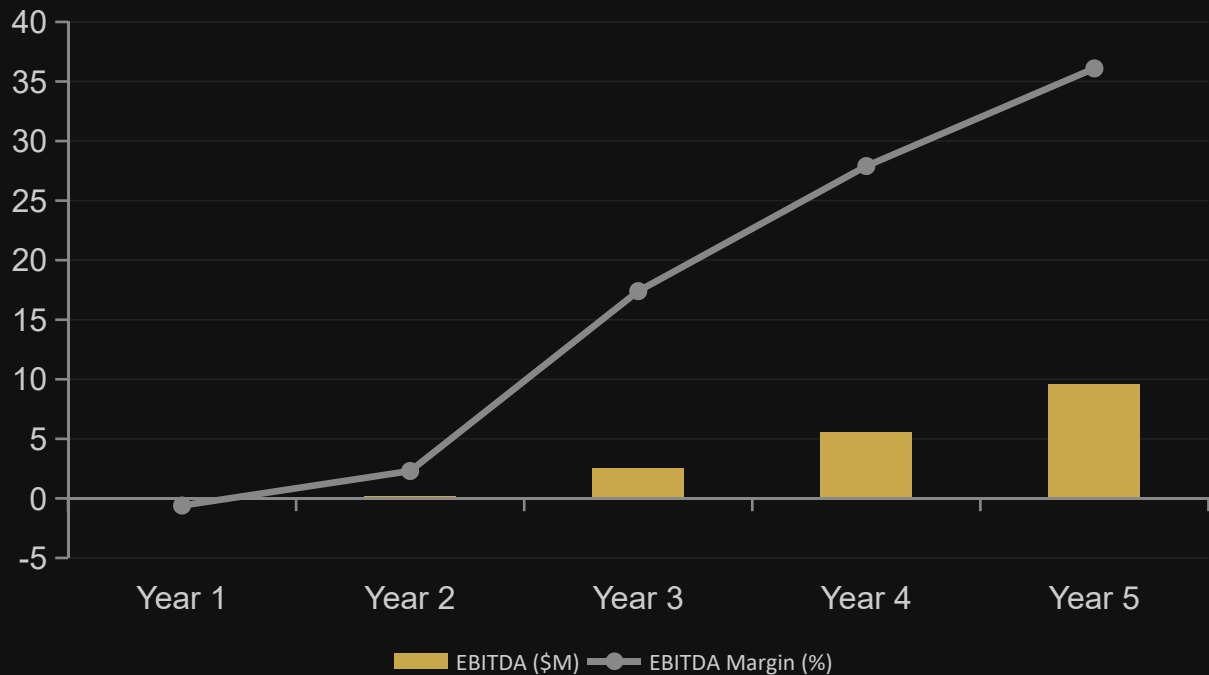
Total Revenue Growth
Y1 → Y5

97K → 290K

Total Orders
Y1 → Y5

EBITDA & Margin Expansion

Path from near breakeven to 36% EBITDA margin



(0.6%)

Year 1
EBITDA Margin

4.1%

Year 2
EBITDA Margin

15.8%

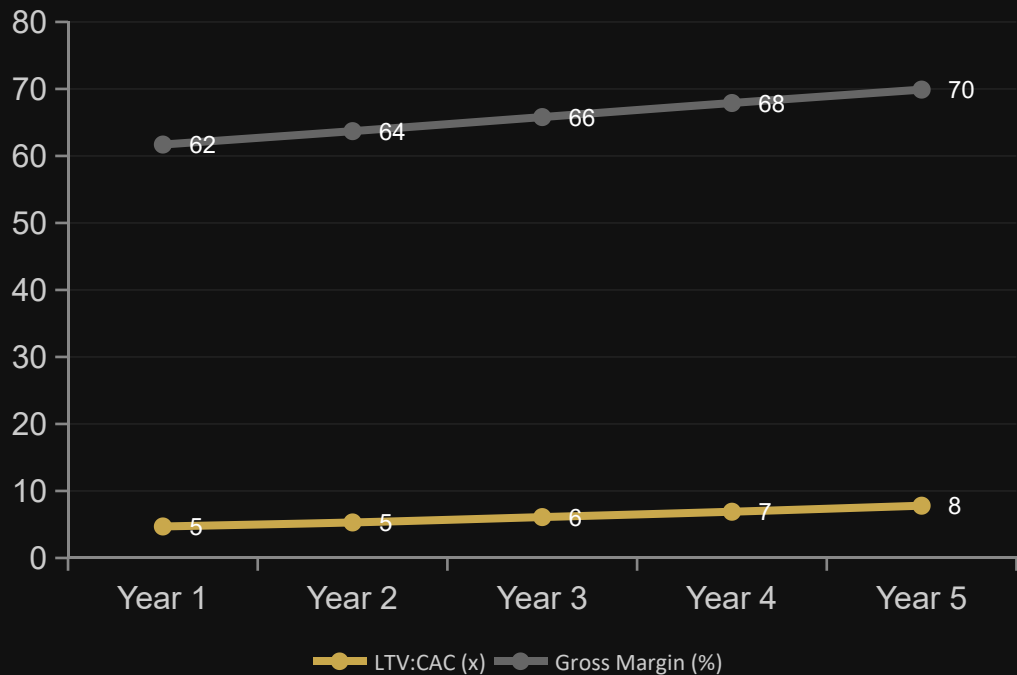
Year 3
EBITDA Margin

31.2%

Year 5
EBITDA Margin

LTV:CAC Progression & Margin Quality

Unit economics improving every year as repeat purchasing compounds



4.7x

LTV:CAC, Year 1

7.8x

LTV:CAC, Year 5

\$80

Blended AOV, Year 1

\$92

Blended AOV, Year 5

\$35

Blended CAC

Competitive Landscape & Category Dynamics

Premium clean beauty — a large, growing, and fragmented market

\$22B+

US Clean Beauty Market (2025E)

Growing at 8-10% annually; DTC penetration accelerating post-pandemic.

<5%

Top 10 Brands' Combined Share

Highly fragmented — no dominant DTC clean beauty player at scale.

3–7x Revenue

Peer Transaction Multiples (at scale)

Large, mature assets; entry valuation reflects current scale and profitability.

65+ NPS

Solene Skincare Co. Promoter Score

Above-category average; driven by formula quality and founder authenticity.

Note: Entry valuation reflects current scale and profitability; peer transactions represent larger, mature assets.

Product Portfolio & SKU Strategy

Disciplined SKU architecture driving premium positioning and margin

Category	Current SKUs	Year 5 Plan	% of Y1 Revenue
Facial Serums	4	6	42%
Moisturizers	3	5	28%
Cleansers	2	3	18%
Treatment / Masks	1	2	12%
Body Care (Y3–4)	—	3–4	—
SPF / Sun Care (Y5)	—	1–2	—

*Sub-3% return rate | <1.2% chargeback rate | >65 NPS across all channels
Clean formulations, no synthetic fragrances, dermatologist-tested across all SKUs*

Supply Chain & Operational Infrastructure

Lean operations built for scale — inventory turns improving, fulfillment diversified

4.1x → 4.9x

Inventory Turns
Year 1 → Year 5

2

3PL Fulfillment Partners
(US & Canada)

3

Contract Manufacturers
(No single-source dependency)

<1.2%

Chargeback Rate

Tech Stack & Digital Infrastructure

Scalable, modern stack — no rebuilds required at close

Shopify Plus · E-Commerce

Primary DTC storefront. Subscription app integrated. Headless-ready.

Meta / Google Ads · Paid Acquisition

All pixels live. Full attribution model. Creative rotation automated.

Klaviyo · Email & SMS

60K+ subscribers. Lifecycle flows live. LTV segmentation built.

Gorgias · Customer Experience

Unified CX inbox. <4hr response time SLA. CSAT >88%.

NetSuite · ERP / Finance

Full P&L, cash, and inventory tracking. QoE-ready audit trail.

Northbeam · Attribution / MER

Cross-channel attribution. MER dashboard live. Weekly reporting automated.

5-Year P&L Overview

(\$mm unless noted)

(\$mm unless noted)	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Net Revenue	7.8	9.7	14.5	20.0	26.6
Gross Profit	4.8	6.1	9.6	13.6	18.6
Gross Margin (%)	61.7%	63.7%	65.8%	67.9%	69.9%
EBITDA	(0.0)	0.4	2.3	4.9	8.3
EBITDA Margin (%)	(0.6%)	4.1%	15.8%	24.4%	31.2%
Net Income	(0.3)	0.1	1.5	3.4	6.0
Ending Cash	0.3	0.0	1.0	4.0	9.5
Total FTEs	24	28	32	35	38
LTV:CAC (x)	4.7x	5.3x	6.1x	6.9x	7.8x

Source: Leverage Strategic companion Integrated Financial Model.

QoE Indicators — Revenue Quality & Normalization

Key QoE findings supporting the investment thesis

Indicator	Assessment
Revenue Recognition	Point of dispatch; no deferred revenue, no bill-and-hold, no subscription contracts. Chargeback rate <1.2%.
Customer Concentration	No single customer >5% of revenue. No channel >72%. No reseller concentration risk.
Repeat Revenue Quality	~30% of orders from repeat customers in Year 1; growing to ~54% by Year 5. Behavioral (not contracted), but structurally recurring.
Key Normalizations	Founder salary add-back (~\$60K); one-time brand photoshoot (\$85K); transaction fees (~\$45K). Total Y1 normalization: ~\$190K.
Working Capital	Inventory turns 4.1x in Year 1 (improving to 4.9x by Y5). No unusual A/R or A/P positions. Revolver draw reflects seasonal patterns only.
Accounting Basis	GAAP. Clean audit trail. No aggressive revenue recognition. Deferred tax assets exist but not assumed in base case.

Target Buyer Profile & Rationale

The Company is positioned for multiple buyer types across three acquisition structures

01 Strategic / Consumer Roll-Up

Consumer holding companies and DTC roll-ups seeking profitable brands with proven unit economics to integrate into a shared-service platform.

02 Financial Buyer / Search Fund

Acquisition entrepreneurs and ETA search funds seeking an owner-operated transition with founder earnout and a credible 5-year value creation plan.

03 Family Office / HNW Investor

Capital seeking brand ownership with recurring economics, real operating cash flows, and optionality for a later exit — not a near-term fund return.

04 Private Equity (Lower Mid-Market)

LMM PE platforms running DTC roll-up strategies with operational talent that can absorb the brand without a full team rebuild.

Buyer Synergy Potential

Illustrative synergies by buyer type — strategic buyers command a premium for a reason

Synergy Type	Strategic Buyer	Financial Buyer
Shared Services (Finance, HR, IT)	High — immediate cost elimination	Low — standalone operations
Retail / Wholesale Access	High — existing buyer relationships	Medium — operator network
Marketing & Media Buying Scale	High — combined spend leverage	Low — brand-by-brand
International Distribution	High — existing networks	Low — must build
Technology & Analytics	Medium — platform sharing	Low — new build
Revenue Cross-Sell	High — existing customer overlap potential	None

5-Year Expansion Plan

Three sequenced phases — each unlocking only after prior phase proves economics

FOUNDATION

Phase 1 | Years 1–2

- Strengthen retention & lifecycle marketing
- Prove Amazon 1P/3P economics
- Operationalize weekly KPI discipline
- EBITDA inflects positive in Year 2

Repeat rate $\geq 35\%$ | Amazon $\geq 12\%$ of rev

EXPANSION

Phase 2 | Year 3

- Launch wholesale (Sephora/Ulta target)
- First international market: Canada (Q2 Year 3)
- EBITDA margin inflects to 15.8%
- Revolving credit facility fully repaid

Wholesale $\geq 9\%$ of rev | Revolver = \$0

SCALE

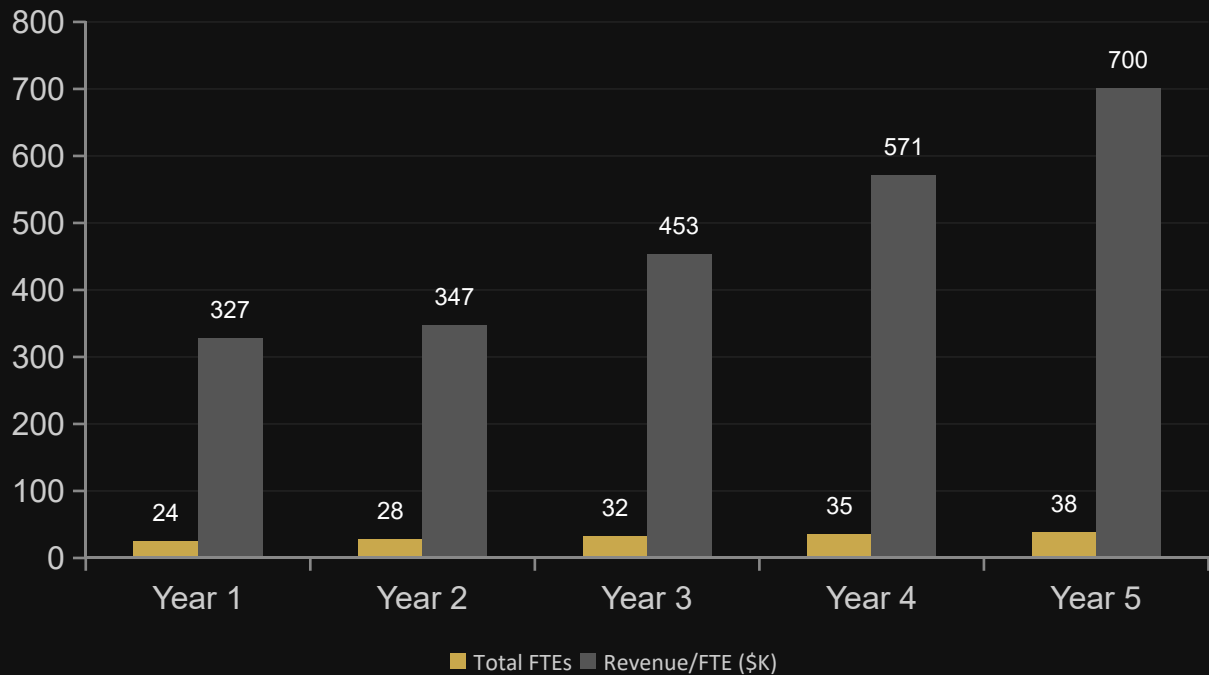
Phase 3 | Years 4–5

- Adjacent SKU categories (body care, SPF)
- AI-driven CRM and retention deepening
- Second international market: UK (Q1 Year 5)
- EBITDA margin reaches 31.2%; \$9.5M cash

LTV:CAC $\geq 7.5x$ | EBITDA $\geq 36\%$

Organizational Scale Plan

Revenue per FTE nearly doubles as operational leverage compounds



Years 1–2 • FOUNDATION

Build retention infrastructure, Amazon 1P/3P, KPI discipline. Headcount: 24 → 28.

Year 3 • EXPANSION

Wholesale launch, Canada launch, revolver repaid. Headcount: 28 → 32.

Years 4–5 • SCALE

Adjacent SKU categories, EU/UK, AI-driven CRM. Headcount: 32 → 38.

Leadership & Governance

Name	Role	Background	Retention Risk
Maya Chen	Founder & CEO	Founded the brand from a personal need for clinically-credible clean skincare. Primary brand voice. 10+ years consumer goods experience. Open to phased exit or earn-out transition.	HIGH — mitigated via transition structure
Priya Anand	Head of Marketing	Owns paid acquisition, retention programs, CRM, and brand content. Built out MER from 2.1x to 4.9x over Year 1.	MEDIUM — mitigated via transition structure
Daniel Okafor	Head of Operations	Runs supply chain, inventory planning, and fulfillment partners. Inventory turns improved from 3.2x to 4.1x under their tenure.	LOW — mitigated via transition structure
Sarah Whitfield	Head of Finance	Supporting, and this transaction process. Prior experience at a Big 4 firm.	LOW — mitigated via transition structure
Jordan Lee	Head of CX	Leads customer experience, retention, and subscription programs. NPS maintained above 65 across all channels.	LOW — mitigated via transition structure

Key Risks, Probability & Mitigants

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Founder dependency / key-person risk	Medium	High	Leadership team covers marketing, ops, finance, and CX. Transition structure (earn-out, phased exit) contractually embedded.
CAC inflation — rising paid acquisition costs	Medium	Medium	Repeat revenue already >30% of orders in Year 1, growing to 50%+ by Year 5. Structural shift reduces reliance on paid acquisition.
Channel concentration in DTC	Medium	Medium	Roadmap diversifies into Amazon, wholesale, and international over 5 years; each sequenced after prior channel proves.
Inventory & working capital risk	Low	Medium	Inventory turns improve 4.1x → 4.9x; revolver sized with headroom to cover seasonal swings.
SKU / new channel execution risk	Medium	Medium	Phased sequencing — new channels launched only after current channels prove economics. No simultaneous pivots.
Competitive / category disruption	Low	Medium	Repeat economics and brand equity create switching costs. Premium positioning insulates from mass-market commoditization.

Illustrative Valuation — Football Field

Anchored on near-term revenue, Year 3 profitability, and discounted cash flow

Note: Entry valuation reflects current scale and profitability; peer transactions represent larger, mature assets.

Methodology	Basis	Low	Mid	High
Revenue Multiple (Year 1 NTM)	0.75x – 1.5x × \$7.8M rev	\$5.9M	\$8.6M	\$11.7M
Revenue Multiple (Year 3 NTM)	1.5x – 3.0x × \$14.5M rev	\$21.8M	\$29.0M	\$43.5M
EBITDA Multiple (Year 3)	12x – 18x × \$2.3M EBITDA	\$27.5M	\$34.4M	\$41.2M
DCF (WACC 12%, TV 8x)	5-yr FCF + terminal value	\$18.5M	\$26.4M	\$34.2M
Illustrative Entry Range (Today)	Year 1 entry, pre-scale	\$6M	\$9M	\$12M

Figures are illustrative; actual valuation subject to quality of earnings review, LOI negotiation, and market conditions at time of close.

Transaction Overview — Three Paths

PRIMARY

Full or Majority Acquisition

- Illustrative valuation: \$6–12M at entry (Year 1)
- Founder transition: phased exit or earn-out tied to Year 2–3 milestones
- Target close: Q3 2026
- Full model, 100-day plan, and QoE provided upon NDA execution

ALTERNATIVE A

Growth Equity (Minority or Majority)

- Minority or majority growth capital
- Use of proceeds: Amazon, wholesale, international
- Founder and management team remain fully in place
- Tailored investor materials available upon request

ALTERNATIVE B

Credit Facility (Standalone)

- Term loan: \$1.2M (5-year)
- Revolving credit: \$600K
- Self-amortizing — revolver fully repaid by Year 3 from operating cash flow
- No additional equity required under base case

Why Solene Skincare, Why Now

Real, Repeat-Driven Customer Loyalty

Not a one-time acquisition story. LTV:CAC of 4.7x today, improving to 7.8x — the flywheel is already turning.

Profitability Inflection Mapped & Financed

EBITDA positive in Year 2; 31% margin by Year 5. Funded by a modest, self-repaying credit facility. No equity dilution required.

Clear, Sequenced Growth Optionality

Amazon, wholesale, international, and adjacent SKUs are underwritten but not yet executed — the upside is still ahead of the buyer.

Lean, Full-Function Team Already In Place

24 FTEs run the full business today. No rebuild required — only scaling a machine already operating.

Brand Equity That Is Hard to Replicate

Founder-built clean beauty credibility, sub-3% return rate, and 65+ NPS create switching costs that PE-backed roll-ups cannot manufacture.

Flexible Transaction Structure

Three paths: acquisition, growth equity, or credit facility. Leverage Strategic can prepare audience-specific materials for any process.

Process & Next Steps

1 Execute NDA

Execute a mutual NDA to receive the full data room, Integrated Financial Model, and QoE package.

2 Management Meeting

Join a 60-minute call with the founder and Leverage Strategic to walk through the business, plan, and transaction structure.

3 Receive Full Data Room

Access: Integrated Financial Model (5-year + monthly), QoE summary, 100-Day Plan, 5-Year VCP, and operating budgets.

4 Submit Indication of Interest

Provide a non-binding IOI including headline valuation, proposed structure, and key conditions to advancing to exclusivity.

5 Exclusivity & Diligence

Enter a 30–45 day exclusivity period for full legal, financial, and commercial due diligence. Leverage Strategic coordinates access.

6 LOI & Close

Execute L[] transaction documentation, and close. Target timeline: Q3 2026 .

(\$mm unless noted)

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Net Income	(0.3)	0.1	1.5	3.4	6.0
Ending Cash	0.3	0.0	1.0	4.0	9.5
Total FTEs	24	28	32	35	38
Total Orders (#)	97,698	117,427	169,661	225,950	289,684
Blended AOV (\$)	\$80.28	\$82.22	\$85.56	\$88.72	\$91.88
LTV:CAC (x)	4.7x	5.3x	6.1x	6.9x	7.8x

Source: Leverage Strategic companion Integrated Financial Model.

Facility	Amount	Rate	Maturity	Year 1 Balance	Year 3 Balance	Year 5 Balance
Term Loan	\$1.2M	Prime + 1.5%	5-Year	\$1.05M	\$0.62M	\$0.0M ✓
Revolving Credit Facility	\$600K	Prime + 1.0%	3-Year	\$200K	\$0.0M ✓	\$0.0M ✓
Total Debt	\$1.8M			\$1.25M	\$0.62M	\$0.0M ✓

Revolving credit facility fully repaid by Year 3; term loan amortized by Year 5. Company exits Year 5 fully debt-free with \$9.5M cash.

LEVERAGE *STRATEGIC*

Partner-led advisory for founder-led acquisitions,
growth equity, and transaction finance.

Ready to explore a transaction?

Contact Leverage Strategic to receive the full data room
Integrated Financial Model, QoE summary, 100-Day Plan, and 5-Year Value Creation Plan .

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